

FRESHWATER AIR-BREATHING SNAILS

Snails of the superorder Hygrophila have their mantle cavity developed as a lung; unlike most marine gastropods, they must return to the water surface to breathe. Mainly herbivorous, they are common in alkaline or neutral, weed-choked, stagnant or slow-moving fresh water.



2.5–5 cm
1–2 in

GREAT POND SNAIL

Lymnaea stagnalis
F: Lymnaeidae

Widespread throughout temperate parts of the northern hemisphere, this is a common pond snail in still or slow-moving fresh water.

5–8 mm
3/16–3/16 in



EUROPEAN BLADDER SNAIL

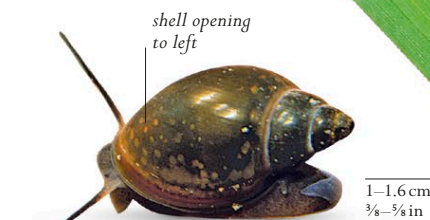
Physella acuta
F: Physidae

Most snails have a shell that opens to the right (when the opening faces the observer), but members of the freshwater physid family have a left-opening shell.

COMMON RIVER LIMPET

Ancylus fluviatilis
F: Planorbidae

Not a true limpet, but a limpet-like member of the ramshorn snail family, this species is common in fast-flowing European waters.



1–1.6 cm
3/8–5/8 in

coiled shell

3–3.5 cm
1 1/4–1 1/2 in

GREAT RAMSHORN SNAIL

Planorbarius corneus
F: Planorbidae

Ramshorn snails have a flat-coiled shell, instead of the spire shell typical of snails. Most – like this Eurasian species – occur in still, fresh water.

LAND AIR-BREATHING SNAILS AND SLUGS

The Stylommatophora are land snails and slugs that breathe air using a lung in their mantle cavity. They have eyes at the tips of their tentacles. Many are hermaphrodite and have both male and female reproductive organs. Their courtship behaviour involves the exchange of spear-like darts before mating.



2.5–4.5 cm
1–1 3/4 in



BROWN GARDEN SNAIL

Cornu aspersum
F: Helicidae

This variably coloured species with a wrinkled shell is widespread in European woods, hedgerows, dunes, and gardens.

8–12 cm
3 1/4–4 3/4 in



COMMON SHELLED SLUG

Testacella haliotidea
F: Testacellidae

A typical member of a family of slugs with a small external shell, this European species preys on earthworms.

15–22 cm
6–9 in



GIANT AFRICAN SNAIL

Lissachatina fulica
F: Achatinidae

This giant land snail from E. Africa has been introduced to many other warm parts of the world, becoming an invasive pest.

3–3.5 cm
1 1/4–1 1/2 in

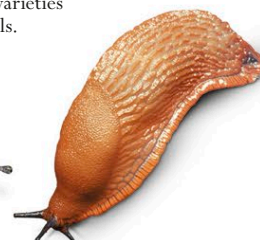


CUBAN LAND SNAIL

Polymita picta
F: Cepolidae

This snail is found only in the mountain forests of Cuba. There are many varieties with different coloured shells.

10–20 cm
4–8 in



EUROPEAN BLACK SLUG

Arion ater
F: Arionidae

Black specimens of this European slug predominate in the north, but other individuals are orange. Although it eats plants, it also clears garden waste.

7–8 mm
1/4 in

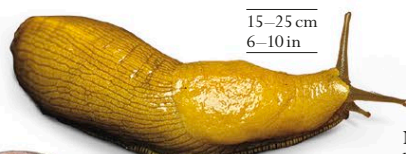


DOMED DISC SNAIL

Discus patulus
F: Discidae

Discid snails make up a family characterized by certain primitive features and a flat, coiled shell. This is a N. American woodland species.

15–25 cm
6–10 in



PACIFIC BANANA SLUG

Ariolimax columbianus
F: Ariolimacidae

Named for its yellow colour, the Pacific banana slug lives in wet coniferous forests on the western coast of N. America.

eye on tip of tentacle

3–5 cm
1 1/4–2 in

ROMAN SNAIL

Helix pomatia
F: Helicidae

Widespread in C. Europe on calcium-rich soils, this is the largest snail of the region and is bred locally for human consumption.

BROWN-LIPPED SNAIL

Cepaea nemoralis
F: Helicidae

A close relative of the Roman snail, this W. European species has a highly variable shell colour, and banding patterns for camouflage in different habitats.

2–3 cm
3/4–1 1/4 in



ASHY-GREY SLUG

Limax cinereoniger
F: Limacidae

Keel-back slugs have a small internal shell. This large species of European woodland exists in a number of colour varieties.

10–30 cm
4–12 in

